# it comes around again

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/35528467.

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Explicit

**Archive Warning:**
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Relationship:**
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

**Character:**
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Part 6 of and they were roommates

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Catradora AUs by n7punk

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## Summary

Catra and Adora have always had a system for dealing with Catra's heats when they come, but now they are together and not just roommates, they are going to need some new rules. It will probably make for Catra's best heat yet.
(Catradora Modern Etheria AU - sequel to 'on the other side')

## Notes

Y'all remember this series? I said I might come back to it, and then I got a comment on an old heatfic yesterday and I went you know what, sure. Today is the one-year anniversary of the first/main fic in this series (OTOS) completing, so it seemed like the perfect time to come back and add another installment.

See the end of the work for more notes

Heats are cyclical, just like periods, but they have more room for error. They are supposed to be every nine to twelve months on average, but Catra's have always been on the shorter side around every eight to ten months. Adora can't really plan for when Catra's will appear, but she sets a calendar notification to go off eight months after her last. It acts as a reminder to start keeping an eye out, but also to sit down with Catra and talk about rules.

This will be her first heat with them together, after all. Both of them have mentioned it once or twice over the last few months—mostly to make jokes about how wild it will be—but Adora wants to make sure she knows the new rules. The talk they had at the end of her last heat is definitely outdated considering what happened immediately afterward. What they already agreed to might end up being all that Catra is comfortable with on her heat, but Adora wants to talk before her hormones go into overdrive and she gets as grouchy as she is horny.

"What's up with you?" Catra asks, her expression and tone amused, when she walks into the bedroom after her shower and sees Adora sitting on the bed, her hands fisted in her lap as she rhythmically knocks her knuckles lightly on her thighs. She isn't nervous, but she did need something to do while she waited. Catra knows her *relationship talk* stance. It has to do with sex more often than not. Adora is more than willing to play around and improvise, but whenever she wants to try something new or realizes she doesn't want to do something again afterwards, she wants to have a clear conversation with Catra about it.

That means sitting down and having a talk, even if it only amounts to a few sentences, to make sure they are both on the same page about it. These talks are usually only a few minutes and not serious. Catra doesn't seem at all concerned as she strolls over to their dresser and collects a drying brush from the tray of options on top of it. Their bedroom is a bit cluttered, but it's too small for two people. They are already apartment hunting for their next place. Their lease isn't up for another two months, but they know they want to go back

to a one bedroom now they are sharing a bed, so they arent staying here.

The apartment hunt is a clear candidate for the subject of today' s talk, but instead Adora feels her cheeks heat and averts her eyes as Catra saunters over and places the brush in her lap. Catra's tail twitches with amusement in her periphery. Catra isnt at all shy about dropping her towel and setting to some gentle drying with it. She will probably tell Adora to brush her for her since she seems to be in a playful mood. Adora will do it happily, but talking is important and she wants to do it first. She likes to do this talks without any other distractions so she can be sure she is interpreting things right.

"Y our heat should be coming up any time now. I wanted to check what the rules were,"Adora explains, shifting to fidget with the brush instead, turning it end over end in her lap. Catra's movements pause for a moment before she returns to running the towel down her body.

"Ugh, it feels too early for it to be coming again. I dont want to deal with it,"Catra complains as she raises the towel up to carefully pat-dry her hair. Adora looks up, doing her best not to scan Catra's body too much before she reaches her face. Eight months together and Adora doesnt think she will ever stop being impacted by the mere sight of her. Catra's expression is thoughtful as she dries her hair, clearly taking a minute to consider it.

"I think it probably should just be an upgrade of what we did before. All our usual coping mechanisms, only actually touching each other this time. Just make sure you ask before we do anything. W e should stick to vanilla stuff. No experimenting, no sex against walls, that kind of thing. Our sex life will probably calm down, if anything,"Catra tells her. Adora nods quickly . They have been comfortable with each other from day one and Adora was a bit *repressed* so it was easy to jump into experimenting with the things that they had always wanted to try, but slowing down during Catra's heat makes sense.

They dont usually have sex while Adora is on her period, after all. If they do, it's just Adora getting Catra of f because she feels too

bloated or cramped or just *gross* for anything herself. Sure, Catra's heat makes her more interested in sex, but it also makes her senses hyperactive and her emotions run wild thanks to the hormones. They have safe words – they established them early on so Adora could always be assured that Catra was just being bratty and not actually wanting her to stop and for similar reasons vice versa – but Adora would prefer that neither of them need them.

They have had a few times where they have had to pull up short because something went wrong for one of them – one time Catra nearly had a panic attack when Adora's dirty talk got a touch too possessive, and another time Adora shut down completely when Catra tried to start something when she was already overwhelmed – and it seems like the odds of having one of those incidents would go up on Catra's heat. Keeping things light and loving during Catra's heat seems like a fantastic idea to Adora.

"Lots of making out sounds good, though," Catra assures her, balling up the towel and throwing it to the hamper. Adora happily nods her agreement as Catra finally takes the drying brush from her and starts working on her mane. Adora will happily give kisses at any time. They might just be her favorite thing in the world – after Catra, of course.

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Adora turned out to be extremely proactive. Catra's heat doesnt come for almost two more months. When it does, she isnt that surprised. She felt grouchy and touchy at work the day before and Perfuma sent her an almost *knowing* look. She felt better after coming home and railing Adora twice – unlike her coworkers, Adora clearly enjoyed Catra's feisty mood – but Catra wasnt just blowing off steam. She wakes up the next morning feeling warm all over, the edges of a fever gracing her brain as she cuddles into Adora's side.

She is really turned on. Not out of the qestion for the mornings, but her hearing has that certain qality to it that she only gets on her heat when even the casual sounds of the morning and street below are too loud. She rubs her face along Adora's front, earning a hand absently falling into her hair and cradling her close, until she reaches the center of her chest, happily marking the tops of Adora's tits before she turns her head to rest her ear against Adora.

She sighs happily as her heartbeat thuds steadily in her ears. She will never be able to explain how comforting that sound is to her. It is comforting in a different way than Adora's scent is, though part of it is definitely the fact that the heartbeat means Adora is close and well. It might have something to do with purring. Adora cant hold a hum in her chest that soothes and heals, but she has a heavy heartbeat that can assure Catra in its own way.

Right now, it is the only sound that Catra wants to hear. She purrs herself as she gently rubs her cheek on Adora with her ear still pressed tightly against her. She can listen and scent mark her. It is a win-win as far as she is concerned. Not that Adora isnt already covered in her marks from last night, but when she is on her heat, she feels a need to leave them constantly regardless of how much Adora already smells like her – though the urge gets noticeably stronger when Adora *doesn't* smell like her.

It's Tuesday. Adora is going to have to go to her internship when she wakes up. She only just finished her final semester of classes for her physical therapy doctorate, but her internship isnt done yet. Catra already doesnt want her to leave, but it' s very likely that her position is going to turn into a full-time job, so she cant call in sick unnecessarily now. Maybe once she has signed the contract, but not right now. Catra will just have to enjoy her while she can.

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Adora wakes up to Catra having crawled onto her chest with her body settled between her thighs – which she has in her hands and is kneading as she plasters her cheek against Adora's chest. Adora blinks down at her, peering a little as Catra's rhythmic purr doesn't even pause. It's too early for *most* things, especially for Catra, but either she is still asleep and acting on instinct, or she is horny. Adora doesn't know why else she would be choosing to knead *there*.

"Good morning," she murmurs, her voice quiet so she doesn't disturb Catra in case she isn't fully conscious yet. Catra's purr rumbles louder she manages to turn her face up to look up at Adora. Even the angle she is at, it makes even a casual glance look like big kitten eyes. Adora feels a pang in her chest that causes her hands to immediately fly up so she can cradle Catra close. Catra sighs happily, pausing for a long moment with her hands flexed, just holding onto Adora.

"My heat's starting," Catra returns, her voice almost equally low, though from her relaxed tone of voice and the raspiness of it, Adora would guess she just doesn't feel like expending more effort to speak louder. Adora swallows, shifting her hands to pet down Catra's shoulders. She is a little anxious, just like she always is around Catra's heats – hell week is hell week, regardless of your species, and she hates seeing her girlfriend go through it, especially given how much worse hers are than Adora's – but she is also kind of excited.

This heat is going to be better than every one of Catra's previous ones. She can ask anything of Adora and she *knows* that. She can hang out naked and forgo clothes for the week, she can come cuddle guilt-free, and she can get off whenever and however she likes. They don't need an excuse to cuddle or be disgustingly affectionate, but Adora likes an excuse to dote on Catra and stay home with her. She bends down, having to use her abs a sit up a little to kiss one of Catra's ears. It is the closest part of her that she can reach, but she wants to give her the affection.

"Want me to call in for you?" she asks, resuming her petting along Catra's shoulders. They are both naked – it is just how they sleep when it isn't too cold for it – so she and Catra both get the direct contact that they prefer. Adora loves to have the softness of Catra's fur against her, and especially when she is on her heat, Catra prefers direct touch as well. Catra rubs her cheek against Adora's chest. Adora isn't certain if she is doing that to mark her or if it is meant to be a nod.

"Yeah. I'll take the next two or three days off probably. You have to go to work though," Catra tells her, the final line almost stern, like she expects Adora to argue. Maybe she would if it weren't for the fact that her boss has told her they are considering her for a permanent position, but that job would pay better than her internship and part-time job at the rec center combined. Not by much, but it would be better for a lot of reasons, and the pay is only one of them. She would finally be working her dream job, getting to help people through their injuries and recovery. She can't lose an opportunity like this. She will have to make do with the time they get together in the evenings and mornings.

"Okay. Am I allowed to move to get my phone?" Adora asks. Predictably, Catra growls against her chest. Adora does her best to pretend that doesn't turn her on, even though they both know that it's a goddamn lie. Catra's tail lashes back and forth behind her as she pointedly kneads at Adora's thighs.

"Not yet," she returns, her voice low and rough. Adora feels a slight shiver run down her spine. Yeah, she didn't think so.

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Normally Catra really wants to be touched during her heat, and she definitely still does, but they don't have time to do that this morning if

she is going to get the other thing she wants – to sink down between Adora's thighs and be utterly *surrounded* by her. Catra can touch herself in their bed after Adora goes to work. For now, she settles on the bed with each of Adora's legs thrown over her shoulders, her feet braced against the mattress behind her as Catra licks over her with long swipes of her tongue.

The muscles of Adora's thighs jump and quiver on either side of her head, surrounding her as her tongue is coated in Adora's slick and her nose is filled with her scent. There might as well be nothing in the world but Adora, street noise forgotten as Catra sets on lapping her up like she is a fucking delicacy. She kind of always loves how her girlfriend tastes, but it seems that it is amplified on her heat. This didn't usually feature as the most prominent of her fantasies during her previous heats, but now Catra feels like she could happily stay between Adora's legs for the rest of her life.

She wants to get her off if only so she doesn't leave her hanging at work all day, but fuck, this really is just about sinking every one of her senses into Adora. She feels, tastes, smells, and *hears* nothing but Adora wrapped around her. Adora's moans are soft and panting, but they fill the room, beautiful refrains of high whines tinging her breathes as she gets more and more worked up by the swipe of Catra's tongue against her. She eats her out like she is her last fucking meal, settling to suck against her clit only when Adora gets so wound up that her legs start twitching involuntarily.

After spending so long at the mercy of Catra's tongue, it doesn't take long for all of Adora's noises to morph into a thin whine. She fists the sheets as she finally comes. Catra still doesn't pull away , reveling in the twitch of Adora's muscles beneath her tongue. She cleans her up with long swipes, settling to nip and lick along her inner thighs when Adora gives the slightly-pained whine that warns Catra she is too sensitive from coming to keep going. Catra can't just stop and suddenly be without Adora, so she eases them both out of it with the attention to her thighs before reluctantly crawling her way up the bed

to drape across Adora's chest and tuck her face in against her pulse point.

Adora finally releases the bedsheets and wraps her arms around Catra instead, still breathing heavily, but she couldn't smell more contented. Catra purrs to herself, feeling equally satisfied despite how she is still dripping herself. It isn't going to take her long with her hand to get off after this. It was the best start to the morning that she could ask for.

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Adora is reluctant to leave Catra, but she does have to go to work and they both know it. Despite Catra not getting off herself and being so worked up now that she is twitchy, she assures Adora that she is fine and Adora is going to be late if she takes any longer to get up. Adora reluctantly heads to shower, needing to quickly wash off the scent of sex before she can go to work.

She leaves Catra in the bed, snuggled down in the sheets and purring, but she doesn't stay there. The toilet flushing seems to act as a signal, because Adora has just stepped in the shower when the bathroom door cracks open and Catra slips inside. She has pulled on one of Adora's shirts – specifically the pajama top that she is only occasionally using – but she is naked from the waist down. For a second Adora thinks she needs something, but then Catra gives her a downright lecherous grin and leans back against the wall beside the glass shower wall.

"Hurry up, Adora. You don't have long," Catra points out, her tone smug. That is the exact moment that Adora realizes she intends to watch from the dry safety of the other side of the glass. If Adora hadn't just gotten off, she would be flushing with desire. Actually, she still kind of is, but her libido is satisfied after the wicked things that

Catra did with her tongue. Adora swallows and steps into the shower spray so she can wash her face.

Her eyes are closed, but she doesn't have to watch to know that Catra is touching herself. She can't hear anything over the shower spray and Catra didn't make a move to do so while she was looking, but she *knows*. Fuck, this is not what she thought Catra meant when she said she would rather take care of herself after getting Adora off. How is she supposed to wash the scent of sex off of herself when she is aware of what is happening right beside her? There is, at most, a foot between them, with only a thin sheet of glass keeping Catra dry.

The closest thing to coverage Adora gets is the water droplets that gather on the glass and blur anything behind them. There aren't enough to give even a hint of modesty. Catra sees her naked every damn day – they sleep and change in the same room even on the days they don't have sex, after all – but it is dif ferent when she is looking so *blatantly* and fucking touching herself while doing it. Catra knows that she has a bit of a thing for being watched like this, on display j ust for her girlfriend to enj oy the view .

It makes her feel good that Catra enj oys looking so much, and it makes her hot to feel Catra's possessive gaz e on her , laying claim to her without ever having to actually touch her. Usually she talks to her while they do something like this, but this isn't for the both of them. Adora already got off and has to wash the smells off of her. This is j ust for *Catra*, which only turns Adora on more. She turns after washing her face and washes her back j ust to delay looking at Catra even longer.

She knows that she is being watched and though she normally loves watching Catra watch *her*, she needs to avoid getting too turned on right now. She still isn't going to say anything to discourage Catra from this. She would rather rail her girlfriend when she gets home from work instead. She won't – they already agreed to j ust simple sex while Catra is on her heat – but she is going to take her apart with her hands until Catra is coming enough times that she never

thinks about resorting to her hand again. Adora is so worked up knowing what Catra is doing beside her.

"Is it killing you that you can't help, princess?" Catra asks, her husky tones barely audible above the water. Adora gasps out loud, shocked by the sudden words. They only cause her libido to perk up more. Adora turns around, her cheeks blazing, to find Catra standing with her legs spread and upper back braced against the wall. Her hips are arched off the wall and her hand is at *work* between her legs as she looks at Adora with hooded eyes. Adora swallows, her mouth dry.

"Yes. But I'm also trying not to get turned on and it's *difficult* when you're looking at me like that," Adora shoots back, but she sounds too flustered to be properly annoyed. Catra grins at her, her hand never slowing. Adora didn't tell her to, after all. Her cheeks may be blazing, but at least getting on the bus turned on isn't as obvious or embarrassing as doing it reeking like sex. The calmer she can keep herself, the more she can wash away and the less likely it is that anyone will notice.

"*Good luck, princess*. You look gorgeous dripping wet like this," Catra shoots back. Any chance of washing away the scent flies out the window in an instant.

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Catra doesn't come in the time that she watches Adora in the shower, but she takes the edge off a bit. She makes it through breakfast at least and gets to leave a few scent marks on Adora before she heads out for work. It doesn't take her long to work in a round once alone, and though she wants to go for another, she kind of doesn't want to wear herself out. Adora's gaze was simmering

when she left. Catra knows she has plans for this evening. She isnt desperate anymore after the activities of the morning.

She never would have *waited* for Adora before – it was usually more about getting off before Adora was around so she could be normal around her – but now she holds of f going again until Adora comes home, even lasting through Adora beginning to prep dinner and leaving it to marinate before Catra does her best to climb into her arms while she is still standing up. She was clingy when Adora first got home, but she wasnt pulling at her clothes like she is now as she wraps her legs around Adora's hips and makes her carry her back to their room.

Adora eagerly takes her to bed and sets to stripping her. It doesnt take long. All she is wearing is a giant sweaterdress of Adora's that she pulled out of the closet because, despite her not liking dresses in general, it is kind of like wearing a blanket instead of clothes and she got cold in the afternoon. It also has the benefit of providing lots of access and being easy to remove. Catra snuggles back into the nest she has made in the sheets, the dress j oining its contents. She smiles up at Adora as Adora's eyes travel over her.

Her gaz e is dif ferent than Catra's was the morning. They are both eqally appreciative, but Catra' s gaz e was burning while Adora' s is soft and almost wonderous. They are both looking at the same thing at the end of the day – their naked and smoking hot girlfriend – but whereas Catra's cockiness turns Adora on, the soft care that Adora shows her is what really gets Catra going. She likes when she is cocky too, but at the moment this is what she wants. Catra would be fine with Adora pulling a similar stunt while she is showering, but she wouldnt want Adora to look at her the same way . Submissiveness doesnt get her hot like it does for Adora.

The evidence is in how she is already purring before Adora even touches her. Her entire body has been straining for Adora from the moment that she woke up, and though she made things work with the traces of her scent lingering in their space during the day, she is more than happy to go limp beneath Adora's wandering hands as

Adora leans in and kisses her slow. Kissing feels *incredible*. Catra likes it on a normal day, of course, but it just hits different right now. She sighs happily and relaxes beneath Adora, only shifting to arch into Adora's wandering hands as she licks into her mouth.

Apparently being on her heat amplifies the feelings kisses normally elicit. They didn't kiss for the first time until after her last one passed, so this is as much of a revelation for her as it is for Adora, but Adora quickly picks up on the way Catra is going utterly limp with contentment beneath her. Adora's hands haven't wandered further south than her hips and Catra is still soaking, but she doesn't want to move on to sex when this feels so good. Adora knows her buttons – at least her usual ones – and she reaches one hand up to cup Catra's face as she continues petting down her body with the other.

Catra loves to have her face touched. There is probably some biological reason related to scent marking, but she just knows that she finds it comforting to nuzzle into Adora's touch when she is really worked up. It helps grounds her. Adora's touch is always so tender and caring that it calms any nerves that might arise in Catra over being in a vulnerable position. They can make it difficult for her to relax and let go beneath her when they rise up. All they are doing right now is kissing, but she is still naked and dealing with her heat. It is vulnerable, but Adora is safe.

Catra can't decide if she wants to keep kissing Adora slow like this forever or if she wants her other hand to move and finally touch her. Adora is exploring her slowly like she doesn't already know every inch of her body and *soul*, gently squeezing at her hip before lifting her hand and palming her breast. Catra gives a soft sigh as Adora flicks her thumb over her nipple. Adora takes the opportunity to set to claiming her open mouth, but Catra happily lets her in. Adora's taste is on her tongue for the second time today – though in a different way now – and Catra loves it.

Adora's hand pets down and Catra purrs as Adora scratches blunt nails through the softer fur below her navel. Adora breaks the kiss to pull back and smile down at her. Her expression is soft, but Catra

gives a whine of protest, turning into Adora's hand and almost aggressively rubbing her cheek into it in place of the kiss. Adora shushes her quietly – she does that a lot when they have sex and Catra gets demanding, not to be dismissive, but as a quiet assurance that Catra will get what she wants – and holds her hand steady so Catra can nuzzle into it.

"Do you want me to touch you now?" Adora asks, her voice warm and affectionate. Catra scoffs, sending Adora a narrow-eyed look that does nothing to dim the smile on her face. Adora knows the answer, but she is checking in to make sure Catra doesn't get overwhelmed. Catra is touched by the gesture, but she has to act indignant about any delay. Interactions like this are why they ended up setting safe words before they even started to really experiment in bed. With them, Adora can be assured that when Catra is fussy, it is all an act.

She likes to be spoiled in bed. So what, Adora likes to give it to her. The secret is that, at least when she is on her heat, Catra loves to be overwhelmed by Adora. She wants her to fill every one of her senses. She nips at Adora's palm before rubbing against it, still purring. Adora's expression was already openly affectionate, but she looks sickeningly in love as she gazes down at Catra.

"Get to work," is Catra's huffy reply. Adora grins broadly, not at all deterred by Catra's bossiness as she ducks down and *finally* kisses her again. She strokes her fingers a little under Catra's jaw, perhaps unconsciously, as she finally moves her other hand down to trace over her. Catra is ridiculously turned on, wriggling in the sheets a little to press her hips up into Adora's touch as Adora sets to kissing her slow and thorough, their lips sliding in a practiced rhythm. Adora's touch is light in exploratory for only a few seconds before she meets Catra's demand for more and sets to properly touching her.

Adora sets a slow rhythm, but the pressure is firm and Catra happily arches into it, rolling her hips when she needs just a little *more*. The whole time, Adora cradles her face and kisses her. The kisses turn

soft and less involved as Adora splits her attention with the movements of her hand, but Catra is wrapped up in Adora and doesn't particularly mind. Her own breaths are growing shallow now anyway, and that makes kissing harder. All her senses are heightened and trained in on the woman above her, her touch so loving and dedicated as she works to bring her over.

Catra was ruined before Adora's hand even met her, slick spread to her inner thighs from how desperately she needed this, and it doesn't take long for everything to narrow to the point of heat between her legs. She stops kissing Adora back, maybe even stops breathing, as her entire body locks up and then *peace* floods through her instead. Adora doesn't pull back, pressing their foreheads together and continuing to hold her close as she works her through it. Catra isn't aware of much, purring as her blood rushes into her ears, but at one point Adora's hand leaves her, no doubt so she can wipe it off in the sheets, because it is mostly dry when it returns to pet over her again like she did at the beginning.

"I love you so much. I feel so lucky to get to do this now ," Adora breathes to her before pressing a kiss to the cheek that Catra doesn't have buried in her touch. Catra is still a bit breathless, but the rumble of her purr rises in agreement. The only good part of previous heats was that she had an excuse to crawl into Adora's arms for a week and get to experience a bit of what they would have if they were together. That advantage is gone now that Catra gets to have that all the time, but she feels so much more content getting to have Adora in every way that she always wanted to. Even the satisfaction settling deep in her bones now, it seems that the ability to kiss, touch, and cuddle is going to make this heat her most bearable one yet.

"I love you too," she replies, her words a bit slurred from contentment, but she feels Adora grin against her cheek before she brushes another soft kiss against it and then sets to wrapping her free arm around Catra so she can hold them close together. Catra rumbles, nuzzling into Adora's hand again. It is already covered in

her marks, but it just feels nice to do. It is comforting how well Adora knows her at this point, providing her with exactly what she needs. She doesnt pull away as she shifts them to be tilted on their sides, allowing them to press tightly together with no gap now that she isnt trying to work her hand between the two of them.

Catra only slips her cheek from Adora's hand to tuck down into her neck and bury her nose against Adora's pulse point, still rumbling loudly. Adora immediately wraps both arms around her and kisses the top of her head. Catra happily relaxes into her arms, surrounded by her scent and warmth. Her heartbeat is still slowing down and she has yet to register anything outside of the comfortable nest of bedding –and now clothing –that surrounds them. Adora will have to get up eventually to actually go cook dinner, but Catra can follow her and perch on the counter to stay close by. Maybe theyll even have sex there.

Yeah, this heat is definitely going to be her best yet. She can deal with the emotional rollercoaster if Adora is going to be strapped in for the ride with her.

End Notes

I have an ongoing fic right now, but I just wanted to take a quick break to write this since it was on the mind.
This fic just covers the first day of Catra' s next heat after the main story of OTOS, but if I end up wanting to write more later (in a few days, or weeks, or a year) I might tack it onto this as more chapters covering the other days. For now though, this is stand alone.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!